D Major

Scale Practice Worksheet · 2 sharps (F♯, C♯) · 4 octaves

About This Key

D major introduces playing from black keys. F♯ and C♯ serve as landmarks and the scale sits comfortably under the hand once the positions are familiar.

SCALES

01 Scale — Parallel Motion

Play D major up and down across 4 octaves, both hands moving in the same direction. Begin in one octave to warm the hands before extending to four.

02 Scale — Contrary Motion

Same scale, hands moving in opposite directions simultaneously. Both hands begin on D, one ascending and one descending.

03 Scale in Thirds

Play the D major scale in intervals of a third — two notes a third apart, both hands together.

TIP
Isolate the left hand if it feels unclear. Do not combine hands until each hand is stable alone.

04 Scale in Tenths

Play the scale in tenths — an octave plus a third between hands — both hands together. Practice both ascending and descending.

05 Scale in Sixths

Play the D major scale in sixths — notes a sixth apart in each hand simultaneously. Practice in triplets.

> **TIP**
> When practicing slowly, lift the fingers slightly higher than you would at speed. At full speed, return to staying close to the keyboard.

06 Octaves — Accent & Rhythmic Variations

Play the scale in octaves. Apply accent groupings progressively.

a Accent every note — deliberate weight on each octave.

b Accent every second note — a grouped, rolling feel.

c Triplet groupings — organize the octaves in threes.

d Groups of four — accent every fourth octave.

Then isolate: practice using only the thumb, then only the 5th finger.

Dynamic shaping: begin quietly, crescendo to forte at the midpoint, then return to piano on the way down.

> **TIP**
> Singing along while you play reinforces rhythm and phrasing.

ARPEGGIOS & CHORDS — TONIC

07 Arpeggios — Short

Play **D** – **F♯** – **A** broken triads across 4 octaves. Root position, 1st inversion, 2nd inversion. Both hands.

08 Chords — Warm-Up

Play solid four-note D major chords. Octave first, then add the middle voices one at a time.

TECHNIQUE
Engage the upper back for tone. Arms alone produce a thin, pushed sound.

09 Broken Chords

Play **D – F♯ – A – D** in broken form across the keyboard, through all inversions. Use the 4th finger where the stretch would otherwise be too large.

TIP
All notes must be equal in weight. The thumb tends to accent — listen for it and correct deliberately.

10 Long Arpeggios

Extended arpeggios **D – F♯ – A – D – F♯ – A – D** across the full keyboard. Root position, 1st inversion, 2nd inversion. Add contrary motion once stable. Separate hands before combining.

Fingering note for F♯: in the 1st inversion, the left hand plays the 3rd finger on F♯, the right hand plays the 4th. Identify this in each inversion and give it extra attention before combining hands.

TIP
To correct a lazy or inaccurate finger, practice with a deliberate accent and prolonged note on that finger only until it responds reliably. When tired, slow down — fatigue destroys legato.

SIX-CHORD SEQUENCE

11 Six-Chord Sequence

Practice the full sequence as arpeggios, broken chords, solid chords, and long arpeggios. Always finish on D.

1) **D major** — I (root position)

2) **D minor** — i (root position)

3) **B major** — VI (1st inversion)

4) **B minor** — vi (1st inversion)

5) **G major** — IV (2nd inversion)

6) **G minor** — iv (2nd inversion)

DOMINANT — A7

12 A7 Exercises (Arpeggios, Broken Chords, Chords, Long Arpeggios)

Repeat exercises 7–10 using **A – C♯ – E – G** (V7 of D major). All inversions: root, 1st, 2nd, 3rd. Octave first, then add inner voices one at a time.

> TIP
> The four-note stretch is larger than the tonic triad. Do not play dominant seventh exercises cold.

FINISHING

13 Chromatic Scale

Play the chromatic scale starting from D across the full keyboard. Extend by playing in different intervals: octaves, thirds, sixths, or tenths.

GENERAL PRACTICE PRINCIPLES

- Allow imperfections when the hands are cold. Start slow — evenness matters more than speed at the outset.
- Practice separate hands before combining for arpeggios and inversions. Combining too early hides individual weaknesses.
- Slow and fast practice train different things. Always include fast practice — it builds stamina that slow practice cannot. Push the tempo, or use a metronome.